ABC TECHNOLOGIES ? INTERNAL AUDIT REPORT

Reference: AUD-2026-001
Audit Period: Q4 2025 / January 2026
Report Date: 15 January 2026
Prepared by: Internal Audit Team
Reviewed by: Chief Information Security Officer
Classification: Confidential ? Internal Use Only

This report presents findings from the internal audit conducted for ABC Technologies covering the period Q4 2025 through January 2026. The audit assessed compliance with ISO/IEC 27001 controls across the IT Operations, HR, Finance, and Engineering departments.

Report Status: Draft ? Pending Compliance Officer Approval

1. AUDIT SCOPE AND METHODOLOGY

1.1 Scope
This internal audit covers the following information-security controls:
- Control SEC-014: Employee Access Reviews (IT Operations)
- Control SEC-006: Network Security Management (IT Operations)
- Control SEC-012: Asset Inventory Management (IT Operations)
- Control SEC-003: Cryptographic Controls (Engineering)

Controls were assessed against the evidence expectations defined in the ABC Technologies control register. Sampling methodology was used for access reviews, with 100% coverage of privileged accounts.

1.2 Methodology
- Document review: policies, previous audit reports, evidence submissions
- Interviews: IT Operations Manager, HR Manager, Engineering Lead
- Technical inspection: active directory exports, firewall rules, asset lists
- Previous audit reference: See audit AUD-2025-004 (October 2025)

1.3 Audit Period
Fieldwork was conducted between 05 January 2026 and 15 January 2026.
Evidence was collected covering the period 01 October 2025 to 15 January 2026.

2. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Three findings were identified during this audit cycle. One finding is rated High severity and two are rated Medium severity.

FINDING SUMMARY TABLE

ID	Control	Title	Severity	Dept
F1	SEC-014	Employee Access Reviews ? Incomplete	High	IT Operations
F2	SEC-006	Network Segmentation Gap	Medium	IT Operations
F3	SEC-012	Asset Inventory Gaps	Medium	IT Operations

Overall compliance posture for ABC Technologies remains adequate in most areas. However the access review gap (F1) represents a material risk and requires immediate remediation before the next quarterly review window.

The findings from the previous audit cycle (AUD-2025-004, October 2025) included a similar access review gap that was partially remediated but not fully closed. This recurrence increases severity.

Auditors recommend expedited completion of access reviews for all IT Operations accounts within 14 days of this report date (15 January 2026).

3. DETAILED FINDINGS

FINDING F1: Employee Access Reviews ? Incomplete Approval Records
Control: SEC-014 Employee Access Reviews
Department: IT Operations
Severity: High
Status: Open
Report Date: 15 January 2026

DESCRIPTION
During the review of employee access records for the IT Operations department, it was found that the quarterly access review for Q4 2025 has not been completed. Specifically:

1. Access review records are incomplete for 15 of 42 user accounts in the IT Operations team.
2. Signed access review records with approval from the IT Operations Manager are missing for all 8 privileged accounts (admin-level system access).
3. Three former employees (departed September?November 2025) retain active system access to production environments as of 15 January 2026.
4. The HR sign-off confirming leavers were processed is absent.

EVIDENCE REQUIRED (per Control SEC-014 expectation)
Signed access review record with approval from IT Operations Manager and HR, covering all privileged accounts and application access lists.

EVIDENCE REVIEWED
- Active Directory export dated 10 January 2026
- HR leaver list (Q4 2025) ? received; no corresponding access revocation
- Previous audit evidence: Access_Review_Q3_2025 ? approved, but Q4 missing

RECOMMENDATION
1. Complete access review for all IT Operations accounts immediately.
2. Revoke access for three departed employees without delay.
3. Obtain IT Operations Manager and HR approval signatures on the review record.
4. Implement automated quarterly reminders tied to the HR offboarding process.
5. Consider quarterly automated reporting from Active Directory to compliance team.

TARGET REMEDIATION DATE: 29 January 2026
OWNER: IT Operations Manager

3. DETAILED FINDINGS (continued)

FINDING F2: Network Segmentation Gap
Control: SEC-006 Network Security Management
Department: IT Operations
Severity: Medium
Status: Open
Report Date: 15 January 2026

DESCRIPTION
A review of firewall rules identified 3 rules that allow unrestricted east-west traffic between the production and staging network segments. This violates the network segmentation policy in place since March 2025.

EVIDENCE REVIEWED
- Firewall rule export dated 08 January 2026
- Network architecture diagram (version 2.1, June 2025)

RECOMMENDATION
Review and tighten the three identified firewall rules. Engage the Engineering Lead to validate that staging-to-production access is restricted to defined CI/CD service accounts only.

TARGET REMEDIATION DATE: 12 February 2026
OWNER: IT Operations Manager

FINDING F3: Asset Inventory Gaps
Control: SEC-012 Asset Inventory Management
Department: IT Operations
Severity: Medium
Status: Open
Report Date: 15 January 2026

DESCRIPTION
The current asset inventory is missing 12 endpoints added in Q4 2025 (end-user laptops and two servers). Asset classification labels are absent for 5 existing records.

RECOMMENDATION
Update the asset inventory to include all Q4 2025 additions and apply classification labels per the Data Classification Policy (Control SEC-016).

TARGET REMEDIATION DATE: 05 February 2026
OWNER: IT Operations Manager